

Minutes of the EADM Board meeting February 2013 in Amsterdam

February 4th 2013

by Michel Handgraaf

Present: Nicolao Bonini, Cilia Witteman, Michael Schulte-Mecklenbeck, Barbara Summers, Michel Handgraaf

1. Opening

Nicolao welcomes everyone.

2. Minutes of the 2011 meeting

The minutes of the 2011 board and business meetings are approved without changes.

3. Elections

We discuss who is allowed to nominate. According to the bylaws members can nominate. We decide to not make it a requirement that members who nominate have also paid for the current year. Nicolao suggests to contact nominees to ask them about seriousness as well as availability. Michael and Michel will continue to update the membership database and the email addresses of members.

4. Activities 2011-2012

a. Newsletter and web content

- Nicolao has had problems reading his own column and Barbara had the same problem. Michael reports that the problem is Internet explorer. Logging in has been an issue as well. It is decided to discuss this under the header Website.
- Michael has discussed integration of Dan Goldstein's Decision Science News in the website. Dan was reluctant. Currently there is a rss feed on our website, which suffices. Michael will do some more content in the future.
- Four book reviews are out, one came back. Michael suggests more book reviews.
- Michael says there is no real newsletter anymore that is sent out via the mailing list. It is just on the webpage. Barbara argues that an email with links is more useful. Will also increase traffic to eadm.eu. Michel proposes a monthly list with links to members.
- Nicolao asks which list of emails we use, it is the one masterlist I have in Ellins' excel. Michel proposes to let Ellin look for most recent addresses for all members
- Neda is doing a nice job on the agenda, maybe in the future she'll need to be replaced.
- Cilia suggest putting interviews of Neda with decision scientists online. Add blog to website? Michael will ask.
- Michel will put minutes online.

b. Workshops.

- There has been a decrease in requests (used to be 4, now two, none in 2011). Michel suggest that two workshops is enough if we have summerschool. Michael suggest to just leave the offer for workshops. Not necessary to push workshops.
- Nicolao asks whether the number of workshops should be lessened in the years that there is a summerschool, we agree not to do that, keep number of workshops same every year (old rules), and summerschool is separate issue.
- Nicolao's request for a workshop is approved.
- Cilia reiterates the point of requests for sponsorships of recurrent workshops. Its agreed that this is allowed. Rules used to be no money for recurrent. Now we agree

that new workshops get preference, but recurrent is fine if there is money. Max 9000 per year total for workshops. We decide not to make a problem of the fact that people have a smaller chance if they apply late in the year.

c. Summerschool

- Nicolao thanks Cilia, Barbara, and especially Tim Rakow and speakers for the great and succesful organization of the summerschool.
- There is one proposal from Shaul Shalvi to organize the summerschool in both 2014 or 2016. [after the meeting it was decided that Shalvi will organize it in 2016]
- It is mentioned that Tim was originally supposed to organize 2014 also, but we are not sure. This has to be checked.
- Andreas Gloeckner was also in the picture for organizing. Cilia will ask him again. [after the meeting it was decided that Andreas will organize it in 2014]
- Nicolao says that we should make clear which years we organize summerschool.
- We see some issues with Israel in terms of costs of travel for students. See email from Nicolao to Shalvi for the rules for organizing it in Israel, we want to make sure students can afford the travel. Nicolao suggests to use the eadm money for student travel and accommodation and the own funds for travel for the speakers. It looks like Shalvi has a good budget to spend on this.
- We decide to first wait for answer from Tim, whether he wants to do 2014. Subsequently Michel will write email to Shaul, and will ask him about 2014/2016. We also decide to ask Andreas Gloeckner.
- We decide we should give credit to Tim (and to future summerschool organizers) on webiste and during general assembly.
- Michael says Ellin should also be mentioned on the website.

5. Financial reports 2011 and 2012

- The financial reports are approved.
- We decide to move money to savings account. We will go down to 10.000 on cash balance.
- We decide we will change bank account to Triodos before summer.
- All other addresses need to be synchronized as well to one address.
- In the future Michel should add line of outstanding payments for the coming year. He will do this asap and send this round to the board soon.
- Another outstanding payment is Ellin's 2012 salary.
- Michael proposes to switch away from 34sp. It's decided that Michael will switch us to another provider.
- We agree that 17.000 is a lot of profit for SPUDM. There were 277 attendees at SPUDM. About 64 euro profit per attendant. The board greatly thanks Gaelle for organizing the spumd and getting a surplus.

6. Membership

- There is a decending trend. Started 2010
- Several factors can be at work:
 - a. General reminders didn't work as great. We need individual reminders.
 - b. Info on the website about individual membership is not correct.
 - c. Problems with our website.
- We decide we should not press people too strongly to pay previous years since there has been so much trouble.
- Nicolao recounts his own experience with paying, everything was fine, but membership still expired. Michael explains we went to a one year membership

starting 1 januari, not from the moment you pay. Michael resets the accounts every 31st of december. Something went wrong. Michael will fix this and will send people email explaining.

- Michael strongly suggests linking membership (2 years) to SPUDM payment. Nicolao says we should also keep the normal payment via the website. In the end we decide to keep both systems (i.e., payment at SPUDM (for two years) and payment via website (for two years). Nicolao suggests to separate the money for the conference and the membership payment automatically through some payment system at the SPUDM website, so the money is separated. Conference fee goes to one bank account and membership to another. We will look into this, this probably won't work for the coming SPUDM.
- We decide that when members pay for two years at SPUDM, it's always the year of SPUDM + the year after. The option to attend SPUDM as non-members should always be more expensive than conference+membership 2 years.
- Michael proposes to stop membership payments now, then at SPUDM people can pay for two years, after SPUDM he will open up the website for memberships payments (only for two years).
- Nicolao says taking away the one year payment will be detrimental to members, Michael suggest that we gain more at SPUDM than we lose that way.
- Membership date is going to be from the first day of SPUDM until the day before SPUDM. We should communicate this thoroughly to the members.
- People who change from student member to full member during those two years pay the lower fee.
- We can send people receipt for one year (60 EURO), and one for free.
- Michael and Michel will get together to find the exceptions (people who have paid multiple years in advance etc.) and deal with them.
- On the financial report of SPUDM it should say how many people paid membership.
- We should ask Elena to make sure that can be done (sending membership and conference fee to different accounts).
- Nicolao suggests asking elena for a budget.
- Michel will chase people who have not paid 2011, but have attended SPUDM and people who have not paid 2012 yet. He will not chase others.
- We will strongly suggest to SPUDM organizers to use something like Eventbrite. This will streamline the payments (membership vs. conference fee).
- Michael suggstst to create a long term relation with Eventbrite, Barbara will check if the current organizers go for Eventbrite or elsewhere.
- Michel will allow people to pay memberships via banktransfer.
- After each SPUDM we'll send an email to those members who have not attended to prolong their membership.

7. SPUDM

- Barbara will check hotels, it would be good to be in the same hotel as the board.
- Organization is moving along according to Barbara. Budget and fees should be known in februari, Barbara will inquire.
- Teap uses an open conference system that Michael suggests as a standard system. We can keep that on the EADM.eu website and have SPUDM organizers use it. SPUDM now uses this partly, for the submission system, for payment we do not know, we hope Eventbrite.
- Beattie and DeFinetti procedures and dates are not on website.

- Jane Beattie award should be updated on eadm.eu (Ellin). Definetti has been updated. Should also be added to SPUDM website
- Next SPUDM in 2015 budapest. Nicolao will check if Richard Szanto is involved enough to learn the procedure.
- Who organizes SPUDM 2017? We decide that could be a proposal to organize SPUDM 2017 in Netherlands. There will be an email to Ido Erev to ask whether he still also wants to nominate Haifa. Nicolao will send.
- There is discussion about safety in israel.
- Everyone will ask around for candidates 2017.

8. New 'Wagenaar' award

- It is unclear who, how and what with regard to the Beattie Travel award.
- Michel will ask Daniel Read what is going on. The form only mentions travel to JDM. The phrase foreign student is strange.
- Michel presents his idea for a Wagenaar award: we pay a yearly fee of \$500 to SJDM for the Jane Beattie Scholarship for travel to the SJDM conference. This way the prize is clear, it's for travel to SJDM and the committee can be arranged by SJDM (committee still made up of American and European researchers).
- We give one prize of x euro for travel to SPUDM (we could ask SJDM for a contribution). [Michel, did we allocate 500€ -a maximum- from eadm as we are doing for the beattei travel award? It sounds strange to put an x prize on the minutes.. I'd say something about how much eadm is going to invest on that] We create the committee (combination of American/European) at every SPUDM, and we pay out the prize at SPUDM. This would be the Wagenaar Travel scholarship.
- Michel will contact Jon Baron informally, asking for info and lining out our plan, then if Jon agrees contact Daniel Read, cc Craig Fox and Jon Baron.
- We will work it out first, then announce for 2015 at general assembly 2013. Michael volunteers as chair of the first Wagenaar committee.

9. Support for JDM journal

- There has been a request from Jon Baron for help with LaTeX editing for JDM. We tried to find someone who would be able to help, but could not find anyone. We offered to help in other ways, for instance by paying a small sum of money for outsourcing the job. Jon thanked and replied that he will keep this in mind. In the meanwhile, he will look for other solutions.

10. Website

a. Financial:

- Most financial aspects have already been discussed, see above.
- Cilia has to update paypal so it goes back to the EADM website. That's a setting that only cilia can go into.

b. Content:

- Michael reports that the newsletter has not been published for many reasons, mainly because of the time that went into recreating the website. It was messy when Michael took over.

c. System

- There were security issues, the site was hacked several times.
- May 2012 we hired a company to fix the site. They did great.
- The website had to be updated to latest Joomla version, and is now much easier to update.

- Michael asks for a change to a new provider, he's not happy with the current one, 34sp. Nicolao says paying more to have more responsiveness with regard to the website will be a good investment. It is decided that Michael will look for a new provider (see also above).
- d. Mailing list
- Mailing list system was changed by our host 34sp from mailman to dadamail, which is a bad system.
 - All this took much of Michael's time
 - Mails arrive at mailing list, but are not sent out, Michael can't check this, but the mailing list works now.
 - It is noticed that the mailing list now has much fewer members. This is because of changing emails, etc. Many people did not subscribe to the mailing list (they had to click link). Michael will try to get people back on.
 - Barbara suggests contacting all the old members. We decide on a two step process: first contact old list, then let Ellin search for changed email addresses. Maybe add a request for signing up to the mailing list to email about memberships if we contact them anyway.
 - Barbara suggests to change the website to having some way to promote themselves, for instance by making the membership list public. We should discuss public availability of the mailing list during general assembly.
 - Michel suggest to put a link to personal homepage at university on the membership profiles. No need to run this by members first, university homepage is public anyway.
 - Nicolao asks can we order members by last name instead of first.
 - We all agree that since we are not quite clear as to what the website's main goal is, it is difficult to prioritize.
 - In the long run, Michael will also switch to better mailing system.
 - Everyone agrees that Michael's doing a great job. Ellin has been doing great work as well. Michael mentions that the monthly meetings of the webteam are going great. Workshop reports have been updated. History of SPUDM is also work in progress.

11. Closing

- We decide to have a board meeting every in-between SPUDMS. January of a SPUDM year is a good time, but flexible.